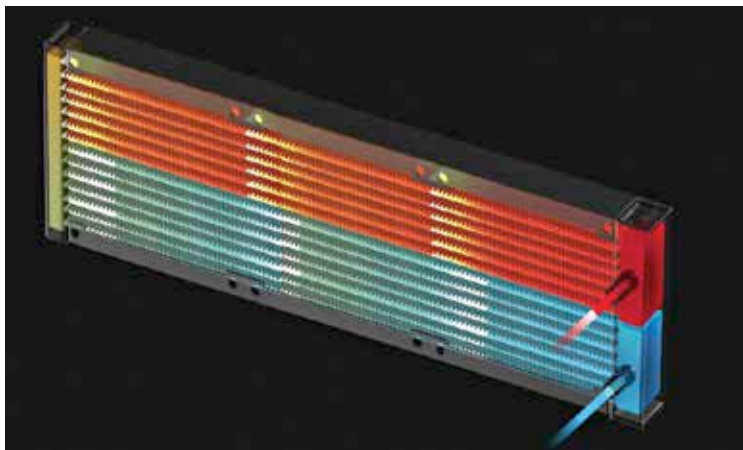




Credit - Cooler Master

A normal radiator

Tubing

AIOs, being rather simple, only have a pair of tubes between the radiator and the CPU block. These tubes are mostly inert since they are made using rubber or polymer. In order to prevent kinking, some premium AIOs come with spiral plastic or metal coils on the inside. This helps reduce kinks a lot. We'll be covering tubing of all sorts in the later chapters, so read those to get a better idea.

Of brands and OEMs

While there are a lot of brands for AIO water coolers out there, not all of them make their own coolers. In fact, the entire industry functions in this manner. So you have a few OEMs which manufacture white-label coolers for these brands to slap on their own custom styling and branding. Asetek, Cooler Master, Swiftech and Alphacool are the biggest OEMs in the business right now. So most of the AIO coolers that you'll see in the market are manufactured by these four brands. This doesn't mean that the other manufacturers don't try making their own coolers. Every now and then some brand will evolve and build their own design. However, when you're in the market for a new AIO cooler, you know that the underlying technology is by the same guy(s).

An important thing to note is that the brand has a more significant say in the design process than just the aesthetics. So, even though the OEM is